

Tag Questions in English

Tag questions are short questions added to the end of a statement, often to confirm information, show interest, or encourage a response. They are extremely common in everyday conversation and are essential for sounding natural and engaging in English. They allow speakers to check understanding, express uncertainty, soften statements, or keep a conversation flowing.

Traducción al español (castellano):

Las "tag questions" son preguntas cortas añadidas al final de una afirmación, a menudo para confirmar información, mostrar interés o invitar a una respuesta. Son muy comunes en la conversación diaria y son esenciales para sonar natural y mantener una interacción fluida en inglés. Permiten al hablante comprobar la comprensión, expresar duda, suavizar una afirmación o mantener la conversación en marcha.

GENERAL FORM:

Positive statement + negative tag

Negative statement + positive tag

Examples:

- You're tired, aren't you?
- She doesn't like coffee, does she?

PRESENT SIMPLE:

Affirmative: You work here, don't you?

Negative: You don't work here, do you?

PRESENT CONTINUOUS:

Affirmative: She's studying, isn't she?

Negative: She isn't studying, is she?

PAST SIMPLE:

Affirmative: He went to Madrid, didn't he?

Negative: He didn't go to Madrid, did he?

PAST CONTINUOUS:

Affirmative: They were waiting, weren't they?

Negative: They weren't waiting, were they?

PRESENT PERFECT:

Affirmative: You've seen this film, haven't you?

Negative: You haven't seen this film, have you?

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS:

Affirmative: She's been working all day, hasn't she?

Negative: She hasn't been working all day, has she?

PAST PERFECT:

Affirmative: He had finished, hadn't he?

Negative: He hadn't finished, had he?

FUTURE WITH "WILL":

Affirmative: You'll come tomorrow, won't you?

Negative: You won't come tomorrow, will you?

FUTURE WITH "GOING TO":

Affirmative: They're going to travel, aren't they?

Negative: They aren't going to travel, are they?

MODALS:

CAN:

Affirmative: You can swim, can't you?

Negative: You can't swim, can you?

SHOULD:

Affirmative: She should call him, shouldn't she?

Negative: She shouldn't call him, should she?

MUST:

Affirmative: He must be tired, mustn't he?

Negative: He mustn't be late, must he?

EXCEPTIONS:

"I am" becomes "aren't I?"

Example: I'm early, aren't I?

USAGE NOTES:

- Tag questions rise in pitch when you truly want confirmation.
- They fall in pitch when you already expect agreement.
- They help keep conversation friendly, interactive, and natural.